MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Introduction

What the exam is, who can sit it, how this course is built, and the route that gets you to exam day ready.

EXAM CCA0-F COURSE 33 modules, about 8 hours MODULE Introduction

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The exam rarely asks what Claude **can** do.
It asks what you **should** do next.

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The exam at a glance

- **Claude Certified Associate - Foundations** (CCAO-F), exam guide version 1.0, effective July 2026.
- **60 items in 120 minutes:** multiple choice and scenario-based multiple response. Each item states how many to select.
- **Pass mark:** scaled 720 on 100 to 1,000, decided on your total score.
- **Delivery:** Pearson VUE, online or at a test centre, in English. About 135 minutes of seat time.
- **Fee:** USD 99 before partner-tier discounts. **Credential:** a Credly badge, valid 12 months, free on-time renewal.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Checked against the official exam page, guide and FAQ on 13 October 2026. Check again before you book.

Who can sit it

- **People at Claude Partner Network organisations only.** Network membership is free for organisations.
- **A partner company email address is required.** Personal addresses are rejected.
- **Aged 18 or over.** No prerequisites, and no coding or API experience needed.
- **Retakes:** wait 14 days, then 30, then 90. At most four attempts in any rolling 12 months.
- **Out of scope:** building on the API, agents and system integrations. Those belong to developers and architects.

> THE TIEBREAKER
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> If your organisation is not yet a partner, sort that out first. Nothing in the course can fix eligibility.

The seven domains, and where they live

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	MODULES	TEACHING TIME
D1 Prompting and task execution	14%	3 to 5	41 min
D2 Output evaluation and validation	21%	6 to 10	64 min
D3 Product and model selection	12%	11 to 13	43 min
D4 Workflow integration and solution design	16%	14 to 17	52 min
D5 Configuration and knowledge management	12%	18 to 20	42 min
D6 Governance, risk and responsible use	15%	21 to 24	50 min
D7 Troubleshooting and optimisation	10%	25 and 26	28 min

THE SIGNAL

Teaching time follows the exam weights. Domain two carries the most marks, so it gets the most time.

The course at a glance

PART	MODULES	TIME	WHAT IT DOES
Foundations	1 and 2	28 min	The exam, the map of Claude, AI Fluency
Domain teaching	3 to 26	5 h 19 min	All seven domains, 198 worked scenarios
Review and strategy	27 to 30	52 min	Sequences, confusion pairs, what changed, question craft
Practice exams	31 to 33	67 min	Sixty new questions, scored by domain
Total	33 modules	7 h 45 min	Plus this introduction

THE SIGNAL

Every time on this slide comes from the finished modules, not from a plan.

How this course was built

- **Topics weighted from a practice bank of 119 items.** It set the emphasis only. No question from it appears anywhere.
- **Every scenario and practice question is new,** written for this course.
- **Every fact is checked** against Anthropic's official exam guide, help centre, documentation and announcements.
- **One finding shaped everything:** almost a quarter of items test the order of steps. So every process is taught as a sequence.
- **Where the guide is silent,** the course says so, rather than guessing.

> THE TIEBREAKER
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> Original questions, official sources, honest gaps. That is the deal.

Claude moved after the guide was written

- **16 September 2026:** the new Claude experience. Cowork features merged into every conversation.
- **No web search toggle** any more. Claude searches when it helps; Research still runs longer, cited work.
- **Memory** became editable topics. **Artifacts** gained Docs, Slides and Design templates.
- **New models:** the 5.5 family, with Fable above Opus. The exam still tests three tiers.
- **Usage Policy update** posted 8 October, in force 12 November. High-risk requirements unchanged.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Answer by what a feature is for, not by where the button is. Module 29 has every change.

Meet Halden Facilities, our running example

	HALDEN FACILITIES GROUP (FICTIONAL)
What it does	Cleaning, maintenance, security and front-of-house, from a Leeds head office
Size	3,400 staff, 260 client contracts, GBP 410 million a year
Claude	Team plan, 180 seats, rolled out in July 2026
Governance	An AI policy, four data classes, and an AI review group
Quirks	Sixteen real-world problems, each solved in the module that teaches the fix

THE SIGNAL

Halden runs through modules 1 to 30. The practice exams leave it behind, as the real exam does.

How every worked scenario runs

01
Situation
Read who, what and the constraint.

02
Question
Note the qualifier.

03
Pause
Stop the video when told.

04
Commit
Choose, and say why.

05
Answer
Every option explained.

06
Signal
The one line to remember.

ON THE EXAM

When you hear "Pause now, and decide", pause the video. Committing first is what makes it stick.

Choose your route

ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO DO
Full route	New to Claude at work, or wanting depth	Every module in order, over two to three weeks
Fast route	Daily Claude users with little time	Modules 1, 27 to 30, then a practice exam; fill gaps by domain
Final week	Already studied, exam booked	Five-line summaries, modules 27 to 30, all three practice exams

THE TIEBREAKER

Whichever route you take, sit all three practice exams. Their domain tables tell you what to revisit.

Getting the most from each module

- **Pause at every scenario.** An answer you committed to teaches more than one you watched.
- **Try it in Claude** where you can. Projects, Memory and artifacts make sense faster by hand.
- **Keep a list of your misses,** and name the wrong-answer family each time.
- **Every module ends with five lines.** Together, they are the whole course in miniature.
- **Re-check the official exam page** before you book. Plans, prices and features change.

> THE SIGNAL
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> The course gives you the judgement. Practice turns it into habit.

In five lines

- **The exam tests judgement:** what you should do next, not what Claude can do.
- **Sixty items, two hours, scaled 720,** for people at Claude Partner Network organisations.
- **Seven domains,** taught in order, with time following the exam weights.
- **Claude changed in September 2026.** Answer by purpose, not by button.
- **Pause, commit, then check.** Sit all three practice exams before you book.

> COMING UP
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> Next: module 1, what an associate is tested on, and the map of Claude.